

Fourth Meeting of the Scientific Steering Committee on One Health

Meeting Minutes

Date: 18th December 2025

Time: 03:00 PM – 05:00 PM

Venue: 33000 D, 3rd Floor, Kartavya Bhavan 3, Central Secretariat, New Delhi – 110001
& Virtual: WebEx Link

The Fourth meeting of the Scientific Steering Committee on One Health was held under the chairmanship of Prof. Ajay K. Sood, Principal Scientific Adviser (PSA) to the Government of India. The meeting was held in hybrid mode; the list of participants is placed at **Annexure I**, and the agenda of the meeting is placed at **Annexure II**.

The meeting commenced with opening remarks by the Chair, who welcomed all participants to the fourth meeting of the Scientific Steering Committee on One Health and underscored the strength of its multisectoral composition spanning health, environment, agriculture, science, and technology. He acknowledged and appreciated the efforts of DHR/ICMR and all stakeholder Ministries and Departments for the successful organisation of the National One Health Assembly, highlighting the exhibits that were presented by ministries/startups/academia, the strong youth participation and the enhanced visibility it brought to the Mission.

The Chair also noted the recognition of India's One Health Mission during the 50th anniversary commemoration of the Biological Weapons Convention as an important framework for strengthening resilience, particularly for the Global South. While biosecurity is not a standalone pillar of the National One Health Mission, the Chair noted and informed the committee that One Health provides a critical enabling framework for addressing biosecurity risks. Parallel efforts are underway with the Ministry of Home Affairs to strengthen biosecurity preparedness, including addressing existing gaps in legislative and enforcement mechanisms related to biosecurity compliance. The Chair emphasised that while pandemics may occur infrequently, biosecurity threats are persistent, and the National One Health Mission is expected to play a significant role in enhancing preparedness, coordination, and resilience against such emerging risks.

The Proposed Model Governance Framework for strengthening One Health governance in States and Union Territories was formally released (https://psa.gov.in/CMS/web/sites/default/files/publication/OHP%20Model%20Governance%20Framework_17Dec2025.pdf). Emphasising the need for robust governance and effective Centre–State/UT coordination, the Chair encouraged active support for the framework's dissemination and adoption.

Thereafter, the chair called upon Dr. Sangeeta Agarwal, Scientist F, O/o PSA, to present the updates and Action Taken Report from the Third Scientific Steering Committee meeting.

Salient Points of Discussion

a. Action Taken Report by Dr Sangeeta Agarwal Scientist F, O/o PSA

A brief presentation was made to summarise the actions taken on the recommendations of the 3rd scientific steering committee meeting held on 26th August 2025. The salient points of discussion were:

- Significant advances have been made in strengthening State and Union Territory engagement, with the proposed multi-tier One Health governance structure finalized and prepared for dissemination.
- The DRDE laboratory has been included in the BSL-3/4 Laboratory Network, increasing the total number of laboratories in the network to 23.
- Nominations have been received from the Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES) and the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) for inclusion as members in the four Advisory and Review Committees. Nominations are awaited from the Department of Fisheries (DoF) post which the O.M will be issued.
- With respect to data integration, coordination has been initiated to align the proceedings of the Technical Working Group on Database Integration with the Advisory and Review Committee on Data Integration and Data Sharing. An alignment framework and concept note are under development, and next steps include the constitution of a working group and a brainstorming session with departmental and State/UT experts to assess data requirements. Actions in this area are currently in progress.
- Progress was reported on capacity-building initiatives through e-learning modules under the Mission. The Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying (DAHD), in collaboration with FAO, has completed a one-month unified One Health training module for State/UT nodal officers (Cohort I with 438 participants). In parallel, registration has been opened for the ICMR course on the SWAYAM–NPTEL platform. To further enhance outreach and scalability, the Committee recommended exploring the iGOT portal as an additional interface for hosting these courses to enable wider dissemination.
- Youth engagement activities for school and college students were organized and showcased during the National One Health Assembly, marking the initiation of sustained youth-focused outreach under the Mission.
- In the area of preparedness and emergency response through simulated mock drill exercises, DAHD conducted an initial planning meeting with the Government of Kerala. Additionally, DHR/ICMR, along with NCDC and other stakeholders, conducted the *Vishnu Sankraman Pratirodh Abhyas* in Madhya Pradesh. The exercise simulated a Crimean–Congo haemorrhagic fever (CCHF) outbreak and involved multiple stakeholders, reflecting

improved field preparedness in areas where gaps had been identified during previous mock drills.

- The Committee noted that a mock drill on animal health emergencies, incorporating a mixed-infection scenario, is under planning with the Government of Kerala. It was informed that a preparatory training/workshop for States/UTs laboratory personnel to be organized prior to the conduct of the drill. The Chair recommended that the mock drill be conducted within the next three months.
- Committee members further recommended that multi-district-level mock drills be undertaken to strengthen preparedness and build institutional capacity. The use of data analytics and disease forecasting for modelling was emphasized, with support from relevant academic institutions, to enable longer-term preparedness and response planning. In this context, DAHD informed that one such initiative is already underway at ICAR–NIVEDI, Bengaluru.
- The Committee also noted that mock drills should be organized in the Northeastern Region. It was recommended that planning meetings for such mock drill exercises may also include representatives from the State.
- The Committee observed that disease modelling initiatives are currently being undertaken for human diseases through frameworks developed at National Disease Modelling Consortium (NDMC) at IIT Bombay, while parallel efforts are ongoing at ICAR–NIVEDI, Bengaluru. It was recommended that these efforts be synchronized to ensure coherence, avoid duplication, and strengthen integrated One Health disease modelling.
- The Committee also noted that the presentation on outcomes of the One Health Consortium by DBT was included in the agenda. Minutes of all four Advisory and Review Committees have been shared with members for alignment.
- Further, the National One Health Mission Assembly was successfully organized on 20–21 November 2025, as per the recommendation of the 3rd Scientific Steering committee to enhance Mission visibility through a national-level event.

The detailed presentation is placed at **Annexure III**.

b. Update by the Advisory and Review (A&R) Committees

The meeting featured comprehensive updates from the four A&R Committees, which elaborated on the discussions held and the planned next steps.

Committee on Bio-Safety Level (BSL) 3/4 Laboratory Network: The Chair of the Committee, Lt. Gen. Madhuri Kanitkar (Retd.), presented the key discussions and recommendations arising from the 8th Committee Meeting held on 15 December 2025.

- An update was presented on laboratory preparedness, diagnostics, training, and network integration.
- Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for BSL-3 laboratories have been launched; the Minimum Standard Requirements prepared by a sub-committee of experts and Biosafety Manual for BSL-2 laboratories are under consultation.
- Priority pathogens have been identified, comprising 39 human and 15 animal pathogens, Gold Standard Kits for diagnosis identified with procurement of the kits underway by each of the 23 laboratories.
- Several capacity building trainings have been completed; the success story of Ebola was showcased on how the preparedness for disease outbreak was ensured using the lab network.
- Progress was reported on discussion for the hub-and-spoke model linking BSL-3 laboratories with VRDL, RDDDL, and CDDL networks, integration with the IHIP portal, and strengthening of quality assurance mechanisms.

The detailed presentation is placed at **Annexure IV**.

Committee on Technology enhanced integrated surveillance and outbreak investigation: The Chair of the Committee Dr. N. K. Arora, presented the key discussions and recommendations since the last meeting held on 22 September 2025.

- A preliminary exercise on collaborative surveillance leveraging digital technologies and community engagement was conducted in Tamil Nadu and Telangana, with the objective of developing State-specific strategies and institutionalising trained community volunteer networks.
- Recommendations included development of SOPs for intersectoral coordination and disease-specific actions, leveraging existing community and governance structures, establishment of community surveillance committees with defined roles, and regular intersectoral review mechanisms.
- A baseline assessment of zoonotic disease surveillance was undertaken in Jaipur, Rajasthan, under the State One Health Action Plan (SOHAP), which highlighted existing surveillance and laboratory capacities, while identifying gaps in coordination, data integration, standardised SOP implementation, trained manpower, and routine capacity building.
- The Committee noted the planned next steps for the year 2025–26, including development of an integration framework for linking surveillance portals, piloting collaborative digital surveillance models in Telangana, Tamil Nadu, and Rajasthan, and optimisation of diagnostic laboratory networks for zoonotic diseases

The detailed presentation is placed at **Annexure V**.

Committee on Research and Development on Medical Counter Measures (MCM): The Chair of the Committee Dr. Renu Swarup, presented the key discussions and recommendations since the last meeting held on 10th December 2025

- An update on the MCM landscaping exercise being undertaken under the National One Health Mission was presented. The process includes structured data collection from Ministries and institutions using a standardized digital tool, supported by outreach and follow-up to improve response rates, and parallel evidence synthesis through systematic literature review.
- An initial synthesis of inputs received was presented, including pathogen-wise and product-wise mapping of diagnostics, vaccines, therapeutics, and other countermeasures, along with institutional mapping and assessment of stages of development.
- A dynamic MCM tracker has been developed to visualize and update the landscape.
- Key recommendations included refinement of the priority pathogen list, incorporation of Technology Readiness Levels (TRLs), periodic presentation of national outbreak summaries to guide prioritization, strengthening and operationalization of the MCM tracker as an open system for stakeholder inputs, and closer linkage of NOHM-supported projects with the Committee.
- It was noted that additional funding for pandemic preparedness is being taken up by the Department of Health Research in collaboration with the Department of Biotechnology.

The detailed presentation is placed at **Annexure VI**.

Committee on Integration of Databases and Data Sharing: The chair of the committee Dr. Vijay Chandru, provided an update on the key discussions.

- The Committee on Integration of Databases and Data Sharing presented updates on strengthening a federated data-sharing architecture for the One Health Mission.
- The Committee recommended constituting a One Health Dashboard Design Sub-Committee for preparing a concept note, to organize inter-ministerial and State-level co-creation workshops to define dashboard indicators, technical architecture, governance, and sustainability.
- It was further proposed to identify four States/UTs for Phase I testing of the One Health dashboard and integrated data-sharing approach

The detailed presentation is placed at **Annexure VII**.

c. Update on key activities and initiatives under One Health Mission:

i) Integration of the One health Agro-ecology project by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEF&CC)

- Dr Clement Ben briefed the Committee on ongoing One Health and Agroecology initiatives aimed at strengthening institutional capacities and intersectoral coordination at national and State levels.
- State-specific interventions include risk reduction for Kyasanur Forest Disease in Goa and improved Albendazole use in Madhya Pradesh.
- The Ministry also highlighted progress on the National Referral Centre–Wildlife, with six regional centres operationalised as a sentinel surveillance network at the wildlife–livestock–human interface to support early detection, diagnostics, and coordinated response to emerging diseases.

The detailed presentation is placed at **Annexure VIII**

ii) Update on the One Health Consortium Project (DBT)

- Dr. G. Taru Sharma presented an overview of the One Health Consortium established to strengthen surveillance and diagnostics for zoonotic and transboundary animal diseases across India, including the North-Eastern Region.
- The Consortium brings together multiple medical, veterinary, wildlife, and epidemiology institutions and has undertaken large-scale surveillance in animals, wildlife, food systems, and humans using serological and molecular tools.
- Key outcomes include generation of disease prevalence data, development and validation of indigenous diagnostics, establishment of biorepositories, and dissemination through publications and training.
- The presentation also highlighted implementation challenges and the need for continued cross-sectoral integration and health systems intelligence.

The detailed presentation is placed at **Annexure IX**

d. Planning one health activities (short / medium /long term) by ICMR along with stakeholder Ministry / Departments

- The Chair recommended that the activities outlined for the NOHM in the SFC note be shared with all stakeholder Ministries and Departments, with a request to provide their inputs by 26 December 2025.

Committee Recommendations

- The consolidated Model Governance Framework for strengthening One Health governance in States/UTs shall be disseminated to all States and Union Territories. Stakeholder Ministries and Departments shall support downstream dissemination through their field networks, including webinars, capacity-building programmes, and translation into regional languages.
(Action: O/o PSA & All Stakeholder Ministries/Departments)
- The activities outlined in the SFC note of NOHM shall be circulated to all stakeholder Ministries and Departments, with a request to share their inputs by 26 December 2025.
(Action: O/o PSA)
- Genomics and metagenomics capabilities shall be integrated into the BSL-3/4 laboratory network. The Committee approved the establishment of a One Health Genomics Consortium, on the lines of INSACOG, to be supported under the National One Health Mission. Capacity-building support, including medical and veterinary training for National Referral Laboratories, shall be explored.
(Action: O/o PSA/ ICMR-DHR/ A&R Committee on BSL-3/4 Network)
- A mock drill on animal health emergencies, incorporating a mixed-infection scenario, shall be conducted with the Government of Kerala within the next three months. To create awareness a preparatory training/workshop for State/UTs laboratory personnel to be organized prior to the drill.
(Action: DAHD along with other ministries/departments)
- To strengthen preparedness, Mock drill exercises should be expanded for simultaneous multi-district drills, including in the Northeastern Region. Planning meetings for such drills should include representatives from States.
(Action: All stakeholder departments/ministries)
- Disease modelling efforts being undertaken at NDMC (IIT Bombay) and ICAR-NIVEDI, Bengaluru, shall be synchronized to ensure coherence, avoid duplication, and strengthen integrated One Health disease modelling.
(Action: ICMR / DAHD / Academic Institutions)
- Proposals shall be developed for multi-district or sentinel site-based surveillance models with structured feedback loops to strengthen laboratory networks and on-ground surveillance. Youth shall be integrated into community volunteer networks to reinforce youth engagement under the Mission.
(Action: A&R Committee on Technology-Enhanced Integrated Surveillance & Stakeholder Ministries & States)
- The next call for proposals under NOHM shall be aligned with gaps identified by the Advisory and Review Committee on Medical Countermeasures, with priority accorded to detection and diagnostics of priority pathogens. Mechanisms to involve private organizations in funding and co-development of medical countermeasures shall be explored.
(Action: DHR/ICMR and A&R Committee on R&D in Medical Countermeasures)

- The Advisory and Review Committees were requested to identify priority gaps, develop proposals, and mobilize funding for their respective workstreams using funds available under the National One Health Mission.
(Action: All A&R Committees)
- Mechanisms to explore involvement of private organizations in funding and co-development of medical countermeasures to strengthen innovation and translational outcomes under the Mission.
(Action: All A&R Committees)
- Ministries and Departments to earmark dedicated budget lines for One Health activities and align existing initiatives with the objectives and priorities of the NOHM. They shall also ensure a continuous flow of information on budget allocations and project implementation status to enable effective coordination and monitoring under the Mission.
(Action: All Stakeholder Ministries/Departments)
- A smaller working group shall be constituted under the Committee on Integration of Databases and Data Sharing to prepare concept note, organize inter-ministerial and State-level co-creation workshops to define dashboard indicators, technical architecture, governance, and sustainability.
(Action: OPSA/ A&R Committee on Integration of Databases and Data Sharing)
- A brainstorming session shall be organized to deliberate on data standardization, interoperability of existing databases, confidentiality arrangements, and identification of data custodianship.
(Action: OPSA/ A&R Committee on Integration of Databases and Data Sharing)
- Clear data confidentiality arrangements, including explicit identification of data custodianship, access protocols, and governance mechanisms, shall be defined as part of the database integration and data-sharing framework.
(Action: OPSA/ A&R Committee on Integration of Databases and Data Sharing)
- Small, focused planning workshops shall be organized to support development of future proposals related to pandemic preparedness and medical countermeasures.
(Action: O/o PSA / DHR / DBT)
- E-learning modules developed on One Health shall be hosted on the iGOT Karmayogi platform to enable wider outreach, capacity building, and standardized training across Ministries, Departments, States, and Union Territories.
(Action: DHR/ICMR/DAHD)
- The proceedings of the National One Health Assembly to be prepared and disseminated by January 2026.
(Action: DHR/ICMR)

The next meeting of the Scientific Steering Committee on One Health shall be convened within the next three months.

Annexure I

List of Participants

1. Prof. Ajay Kumar Sood, Principal Scientific Adviser (PSA) to the Government of India (Chair)
2. Dr. Rajiv Bahl, Secretary, Department of Health Research (DHR) and Director General, Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)
3. Dr. V. Narayanan, Chairman and Secretary, Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), Department of Space, Government of India
4. Prof. Abhay Karandikar, Secretary, Department of Science & Technology (DST), Government of India
5. Dr. (Mrs.) Parvinder Maini, Scientific Secretary, Office of the Principal Scientific Adviser to the Government of India (O/o PSA to GoI)
6. Dr. Renu Swarup, Former Secretary, Department of Biotechnology (DBT)
7. Lt. Gen. Madhuri Kanitkar (Retd.), Member, PM-STIAC and Vice Chancellor, Maharashtra University of Health Sciences, Nashik
8. Prof. Vijay Chandru, Adjunct Faculty, Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru
9. Dr. N. K. Arora, Executive Director, INCLEN Trust International, New Delhi
10. Dr. Rajan Khobragade, Additional Chief Secretary, Health and Family Welfare, Government of Kerala
11. Dr. Praveen Malik, Animal Husbandry Commissioner, Department of Animal Husbandry & Dairying (DAHD), Government of India
12. Shri Rama Shankar Sinha, Additional Secretary (Livestock Health), Department of Animal Husbandry & Dairying, Government of India
13. Shri Awadhesh Kumar Choudhary, Senior Economic Adviser, Department of Pharmaceuticals, Government of India
14. Dr. Clement Ben, Member Secretary, Central Zoo Authority (CZA)
15. Dr. Sindura Ganapathi, Visiting PSA Fellow, O/o PSA to GoI
16. Dr. Ranjan Das, Director, National Centre for Disease Control (NCDC)
17. Brig. M. M. Ramachandra (Retd.), Director, National Security Council Secretariat, Government of India
18. Dr. Vinay Nandicoori, Director, CSIR–Centre for Cellular and Molecular Biology (CCMB), Hyderabad
19. Dr. Nivedita Gupta, Scientist 'G' and Head, Communicable Diseases Division, Indian Council of Medical Research
20. Dr. D. T. Selvam, Scientist 'G' and Director (Project Management), Soldier Support System, Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)
21. Dr. Kadri, Executive Director, State Health Systems Resource Centre (SHSRC), Gujarat, and Member Secretary, State Convergence Committee on AMR, Government of Gujarat
22. Dr. G. Taru Sharma, Former Director, DBT–National Institute of Animal Biotechnology (NIAB)
23. Dr. Naveen Kumar Gupta, Additional Director and Head, Centre for One Health, National Centre for Disease Control
24. Dr. Pragya Yadav, Director (In-Charge), National Institute for One Health (NIOH), Nagpur
25. Dr. Manish Rana, Scientist 'F', Department of Biotechnology
26. Dr. Sangeeta Agarwal, Scientist 'F', O/o PSA to GoI
27. Dr. Anoop Velayudhan, Scientist 'E', Indian Council of Medical Research
28. Dr. Anil Kumar Vijayan, Scientist 'E', Ministry of Earth Sciences
29. Dr. Himanshu Chauhan, Additional Director, National Centre for Disease Control
30. Dr. Adhiraj Mishra, Assistant Commissioner (Animal Health), Department of Animal Husbandry & Dairying
31. Dr. Twinkle Sharma, Expert/Consultant, National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA)
32. Dr. Simmi Tiwari, Joint Director, National Centre for Disease Control
33. Dr. Monil Singhai, Joint Director, National Centre for Disease Control
34. Dr. Madhumita Barua, Joint Director, National Centre for Disease Control
35. Dr. Ajit Dadaji Shewale, Deputy Director, National Centre for Disease Control
36. Dr. Richi Mahajan, Scientist 'D', Department of Biotechnology
37. Dr. Kamlesh J. Upadhyay, Professor and Head, Department of Medicine, B. J. Medical College, Ahmedabad
38. Dr. Shubhangini Pandey, Public Health Expert, Gujarat
39. Dr. Anusha, Representative, Ministry of AYUSH
40. Ms. Richa Chaturvedi, Project Manager, One Health PMU, O/o PSA to GoI
41. Dr. Darshan N., Project Manager, One Health PMU, O/o PSA to GoI
42. Ms. Arundhati Mohanty, Project Manager, One Health PMU, O/o PSA to GoI